

45 Shifting focus

You can add emphasis to part of a sentence in English by splitting it into two clauses. This allows you to focus attention on the new or important information.

 **New language** Focusing with clauses

Aa Vocabulary Phrases for emphasis

 **New skill** Shifting focus

45.1 KEY LANGUAGE FOCUSING WITH "WHAT" CLAUSES

You can add "what" with the verb "be" to a simple statement to make it more emphatic. This structure is often used with verbs expressing emotions, such as "love," "hate," "like," and "want."

Would you like to go to a movie?



No, thanks. **What** I really want **is** to go to bed early.

Add "what" to the start of the sentence.

The information that you want to focus on is put outside the "what" clause.

This has more emphasis than "I really want to go to bed early."



45.2 FURTHER EXAMPLES FOCUSING WITH "WHAT" CLAUSES

What we hated **was** the bad service. **What** I like here **is** the weather.

What they loved the most **were** the museums.



45.3 MATCH THE BEGINNINGS OF THE SENTENCES TO THE CORRECT ENDINGS

What annoyed him the most was

① What I would really appreciate is

② What we really need are

③ What I love about this city is

④ What businesses really hate is

some legal advice.

when people leave bad reviews online.

more volunteers to help during the week.

the lack of communication.

the nightlife and the culture.

